

IPO Alert Platform — Full Build & Business Guide

Benchmarked against IPO Watch (ipowatch.in + Android app)

1. What IPO Watch Actually Does (the model you're copying)

Before building, it's worth naming exactly what makes their model work, because your build should mirror the *structure*, not just the look:

Element	How IPO Watch does it
Core content unit	One dedicated page per IPO (e.g. <code>/company-name-ipo/</code>), which then spins off child pages: GMP, Review, Subscription Status, Allotment Status
Data categories	Mainboard IPO, SME IPO, NCD (bonds), Rights Issue, Buyback, Offer for Sale (OFS)
Freshness signal	GMP ticker strip updated daily, "Today"/date-stamped articles, live subscription counters during the 3-day bidding window
Trust signals	Media mentions bar, testimonials, disclaimer stating "we are not SEBI registered," links out to official SEBI/NSE/BSE/RTA sites
Monetization	Display ads (AdSense-style), broker affiliate links ("Apply IPO" → Zerodha with a referral tag <code>?c=ZMPZQH</code>), an "Advertise with us" page for direct sponsorships, and a companion Android app rated by 5,000+ users

Your job is to replicate this data/content engine, but make the UX cleaner and add proper push notifications (their app reviews mention accuracy is good but the app itself has update/reliability complaints — that's your opening).

2. Core Feature Set (MVP scope)

A. IPO Listings — three states, one data model

Upcoming IPOs — DRHP filed / dates announced but not yet open

Active/Open IPOs — bidding window live (show live countdown: "Closes in 1d 4h")

Past/Closed IPOs — listed, with listing-day gain/loss vs issue price

Each IPO is a single record that just changes `status` over time — don't model these as three separate tables.

B. Per-IPO Detail Page (this is your real product)

Company snapshot: price band, lot size, issue size, face value, IPO dates, listing exchange (NSE/BSE/SME)
Financials: revenue, profit, key ratios (from RHP/DRHP — see data sourcing below)
GMP (Grey Market Premium) — daily updated number + estimated listing gain %
Subscription status — live/day-wise breakdown by QIB / NII / Retail / Employee
Allotment status checker (link out to registrar — Kfintech/Linkintime/Bigshare — or embed their status-check API/form if available)
Anchor investor details, lead managers, registrar
Reviews/rating (your editorial "Apply / Avoid / Neutral" call, like their Dilip Davda review column)
Lead-generation CTA: "Apply via [Broker]" affiliate button

C. Notifications (your key differentiator)

Send alerts for:

New IPO announced / DRHP filed
IPO opens for subscription (T-0)
IPO closing tomorrow (reminder)
Subscription milestone crossed (e.g. "Retail portion 5x subscribed")
Allotment out
Listing day + gain/loss result
GMP moved significantly (optional, for power users/paid tier)

Channels: Web Push (free, works even with tab closed) → Android push via FCM (once you wrap the web app or build native) → Email digest → WhatsApp/Telegram channel (cheap retention channel, IPO Watch already uses this and it's a strong habit-loop for Indian retail investors).

D. Supporting pages (for SEO + AdSense approval)

IPO FAQs, "What is IPO", "How to apply", allotment-tips guide, IPO calendar for the month, biggest IPOs list, top subscribed list — these are low-effort, high-search-volume pages that compound your organic traffic. AdSense approval in particular wants to see substantial original content beyond just data tables, so budget for 15-20 of these evergreen articles before applying.

3. Data Sourcing Strategy (the hardest part, be honest with yourself here)

You cannot legally scrape NSE/BSE/SEBI/registrar sites at will — check each site's terms. Realistic options, in order of how most Indian IPO sites actually do it:

Manual/CMS-driven entry — a lightweight admin panel where you (or a small team) enter IPO details from public DRHP/RHP filings when they're published on SEBI's site. This is what most players actually rely on for accuracy, especially GMP (which isn't an official number — it's a market estimate you or your community source and publish, with a disclaimer, exactly like IPO Watch does: "*We do not claim any facts and figures mentioned here.*")

Public/official feeds you can legally pull — NSE and BSE do publish IPO bidding/subscription data pages and circulars; SEBI publishes DRHP/RHP listings. Treat these as reference sources to check manually or via their documented public APIs/RSS if available, not scrape targets.

Paid data vendor — services like Trendlyne, Chittorgarh (data partnerships), or NSE/BSE market data subscriptions exist for structured, licensed IPO data feeds. This is the safest and most scalable path once you have revenue — budget for it as soon as you're past MVP.

Registrar allotment-status — don't scrape Kfintech/Linkintime/Bigshare; just deep-link users to the registrar's official status page for that IPO. That's what IPO Watch does too.

Practical MVP path: Start with manual CMS entry (1 person can maintain ~5-10 active IPOs comfortably) + GMP sourced from your own market contacts/community, clearly labelled as an estimate. Automate later with licensed data once revenue justifies the cost.

4. Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	Next.js (React)	SSR/SSG for SEO — critical since your traffic will be organic search dominated
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Fast to build a clean, attractive UI; easy to keep consistent
Backend/API	Next.js API routes or a separate Node/Express service	Keep it simple for MVP; split out later if you add a mobile app
Database	PostgreSQL (via Supabase or Neon)	Relational fits IPO data well (companies, dates, subscription-day records); Supabase also gives you auth + storage for free tier
CMS/Admin	Custom admin panel (Next.js protected routes) or Sanity/Strapi headless CMS	Lets non-technical team members update GMP/subscription numbers daily without touching code
Notifications	Web Push: OneSignal (free tier, handles web push + later mobile) Email: Resend or SendGrid WhatsApp/Telegram: Telegram Bot API (free) is a great starting channel before WhatsApp Business API (paid)	
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Supabase/Neon (DB)	Free/cheap to start, scales well

Layer	Choice	Why
Analytics	Google Analytics 4 + Search Console	Non-negotiable — you’re an SEO-driven business
App later	Wrap as PWA first (installable, push works), then React Native or WebView-based Android app once you have traction	Matches IPO Watch’s own path — they built an app after the site had traction

5. Suggested Database Schema (simplified)

companies └─ id, name, slug, logo_url, sector ipos └─ id, company_id, type (mainboard/sme), exchange (nse/bse) └─ status (upcoming/open/closed/listed) └─ open_date, close_date, listing_date └─ price_band_min, price_band_max, lot_size, face_value └─ issue_size_cr, fresh_issue_cr, ofs_cr └─ registrar, lead_managers └─ review_rating, review_text gmp_records └─ id, ipo_id, date, gmp_value, estimated_listing_gain_pct subscription_records └─ id, ipo_id, date, qib_x, nii_x, retail_x, employee_x, total_x allotment_status └─ id, ipo_id, allotment_date, registrar_link users └─ id, email, phone, plan (free/pro), notification_prefs (json) notification_log └─ id, user_id, ipo_id, type, sent_at, channel
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6. Notification Architecture (how to actually implement it)

Trigger source: every time your admin/CMS updates an `ipos` row's `status`, or inserts a new `subscription_records`/`gmp_records` row, fire an event.

Event → Queue: simplest MVP: a scheduled cron job (Vercel Cron or a small Node worker) checks for state changes every 15–30 minutes and pushes notifications. Scale later to real-time triggers (DB webhooks via Supabase functions).

Fan-out: OneSignal handles segmenting (e.g., "users subscribed to SME IPOs only," "Pro users get GMP-move alerts") — set this up as tags on each user.

User control: Let users pick per-IPO or per-category alerts ("notify me only for Mainboard IPOs" or "only IPOs I've starred") — this single feature is a real UX upgrade over IPO Watch's reviews, which complain about the app just breaking/not being selective.

7. Monetization — Stacked Revenue Model

A. Google AdSense (baseline revenue, needs traffic first)

Requires genuine content depth (your FAQ/guide pages matter here), a privacy policy, clear ownership/about page, and no misleading claims.

Placement: top banner, in-content (between IPO details sections), sidebar on desktop, sticky bottom on mobile. Don't overload the IPO detail page — 3-4 ad units max, or you hurt UX and Core Web Vitals (which also affects your SEO ranking).

Realistic expectation: AdSense alone rarely pays well per visit in India (low RPM, ~₹50-150 per 1000 pageviews for finance content is a reasonable planning range) — it's a floor, not your main revenue.

B. Broker/Demat Account Affiliate Referrals (this is IPO Watch's real earner)

Sign up for affiliate programs: Zerodha, Groww, Upstox, Angel One, 5paisa, Dhan — all have referral programs paying ₹100-500+ per funded account.

Put a persistent "Apply for this IPO via [Broker]" CTA with your tracked referral link on every IPO detail page — highest-intent placement.

This typically outperforms AdSense by 3-10x on finance content once you have decent traffic, because it's an actual conversion, not a click.

C. Subscription / Pro Tier

Price this as a small monthly/annual plan (₹49-199/month range is typical for Indian retail-investor tools).

Gate genuinely valuable things, not basic data:

Real-time push the instant GMP moves (free users get daily digest only)

Advanced filters (shareholder-quota IPOs, high-subscription alerts)

Ad-free experience

Early access to DRHP-filed IPOs before public listing on your free page

Downloadable/exportable IPO calendar, allotment tracker across multiple PAN/demat accounts

Payment: Razorpay or Cashfree (Indian gateways, handle UPI/cards/subscriptions natively).

D. Direct Sponsorships / "Advertise with us"

Once you have traffic, sell direct ad placements or "featured IPO analysis" slots to brokers, financial advisors, or fintech products — higher CPM than AdSense, and IPO Watch runs this as its own page (`/advertise-with-us/`).

E. Lead-gen for financial products

Beyond brokers: mutual funds, demat-linked insurance, tax-filing tools — affiliate/CPL (cost-per-lead) deals are common in this vertical.

Revenue priority order for a new site: Broker affiliates > Subscriptions (once you have a loyal user base) > Direct sponsorships (once traffic is provable) > AdSense (background revenue throughout).

8. Legal & Compliance — do not skip this

This is the part that gets financial content sites shut down or fined if ignored:

You are not SEBI-registered (unless you actually pursue an Investment Adviser license) — so every page must carry a clear disclaimer that content is for **educational/informational purposes only**, not investment advice, exactly as IPO Watch states on every page.

Never phrase GMP or reviews as guaranteed returns or "buy/sell tips" — frame as "estimated" and "market indication."

Publish a **Privacy Policy** and **Terms of Use** (mandatory for AdSense approval and for any subscription/payment collection).

If collecting payments, you'll need GST registration once turnover crosses the threshold, and Razorpay/Cashfree will ask for business KYC to onboard you.

Attribute data sources; don't claim you're an official SEBI/NSE/BSE platform anywhere in branding.

9. Suggested Build Roadmap

Phase	Duration	Deliverable
1. Foundation	2-3 weeks	Next.js site scaffold, DB schema, admin CMS for manual IPO entry, 10-15 core pages live (Upcoming/Active/Past, individual IPO pages)
2. Content + SEO base	Ongoing from week 3	15-20 evergreen guide articles, on-page SEO, submit sitemap to Search Console
3. Notifications	Week 4-5	OneSignal web push integrated, Telegram channel launched, email digest
4. Monetization setup	Week 5-6	AdSense application submitted (needs ~4-6 weeks of real content/traffic first usually), broker affiliate links live

Phase	Duration	Deliverable
5. Subscription tier	Week 7-9	Razorpay integration, Pro feature gating
6. Mobile	Month 3-4	Convert to installable PWA first; native app (React Native/WebView) once traffic justifies it
7. Scale data	Month 4+	Move from manual entry to licensed data feed if volume/accuracy demands it

10. What Would Make You Better Than IPO Watch, Specifically

Based on their own user reviews (visible on their site):

Complaints about outdated listings not being removed promptly → build status auto-transition logic (closed IPOs auto-move out of "active" the moment close_date passes)

Complaints about the app breaking after updates → keep the PWA/web-first approach longer before rushing a native app; it's more reliable and easier to maintain

No mention of granular notification control → your per-category, per-IPO opt-in notifications are a genuine improvement

Ad-heavy pages hurting UX → a cleaner design with fewer, better-placed ads plus a genuinely ad-free Pro tier is a real differentiator worth marketing

Want me to go deeper on any single piece next — e.g., actually scaffold the Next.js project structure and database schema as working code, design the IPO detail page UI, or draft the AdSense-ready content pages?